

EPISODE 16 (SESSION 1)

Out of the Pit

PRIMARY TEXT: GENESIS 41–50

In the last Companion, we were left with more questions than answers.

Will Israel find the plot of the Story again? Remember their goodness, God's promise to them, and their promises to God? Is there still hope for justice and restoration?

In short, yes... Because God believes in this family. He chose them for a reason, and He's willing to do anything to prove to them, to us, that we're worth it—that He makes us enough. He made us as His image bearers. He met us where we were at, even in our guilt and shame. He redeems us again and again, asking us to just choose the next right thing. He walks through the blood path, calls us His own, and He forgives us. Perhaps, just as in all other models of greatness, God is our ultimate example of trusting the Story.

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As the book of Genesis wraps up, we know this isn't the end of the story of Israel or the story of God's love for all people. It may take multiple members of Jacob's family displaying different attributes of God to show that they now not only understand what God is doing, but that they are going to choose their role in the story to be one of trust—even vulnerability.

Still not perfect. Still not the "ideal" examples at all times. But we see them choosing to take on the characteristics of God to further the Story. They are choosing the Story as Abram did. Choosing to partner with God in putting the world back together—through the power of forgiveness.

In spite of being betrayed by his brothers, sold into slavery, and thrown into prison, Joseph still has the fire and *chutzpah* of his father, Jacob. Joseph wrestles with the meaning of Pharaoh's dreams. He directs and pushes back enough to change the outcome of what famine could have done to Egypt, and, ultimately, his own family.

In Judah, we see a man who has been humbled. A man who has learned from his mistakes, not one who wallows in them. He chooses to let himself be made new and, quite possibly, it is this transformation that inspires Joseph to forgive his family, inspiring reconciliation.

forgiveness—it puts the world back together.

In doing so, he shows us the beautiful power of forgiveness—it puts the world back together.

In the story of the reunion of the sons of Israel, we see these brothers get forgiveness right. Judah chooses vulnerability and humility. Justice and reconciliation. Others over himself. Joseph chooses to forgive.

This is choosing to trust the Story. This is the book of Genesis coming together to show that partnering in the Story with God and the role we will play in it is a *choice*. We can choose to learn from our mistakes, own up to them rather than sit in our dungeons or pits of hopelessness, and do better next time. Isn't this what God has been asking us to do since the beginning?

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And things seem to play out more peacefully and beautifully when we do make that choice.

To partner with God.

To be more like God.

To set aside the generational curses, and take on our innate goodness.

To be grounded in who God has made us to be, rather than shaken by what the world tells us we are not.

PRAYER

*Blessed are You, God of the universe,
who sought to forgive and forever love me.
Bring about a change in my life
that chooses to do the hard work
of humility, of confession, of reconciliation.
May I remember that Your promises are
for all of creation.
So teach me to get forgiveness right.
To go about the world in Your name
to pursue goodness, to seek justice,
and to take on a role that inspires others
to choose to trust the Story.*

Amen

THE FOUR PILLARS

EPISODE 16

BEMA Discipleship is built on four pillars; a **Four-Pillared Perspective** to help us remember **to elevate the words of God** (not ours) and help us identify the principles that we see recurring in the Story of God's people.

Here are some applications for this episode echoing the ideas of the four pillars:



TEXT

How could you meditate over these parts of the Story? It was a large chunk—make sure you read it all for yourself! What Text could you continue to meditate on, memorize, or dig deeper into?



COMMUNITY

In what ways does your community encourage you and even challenge you to humility, repentance, and forgiveness? Who might you need to seek reconciliation?



DISCIPLESHIP

Who in your life would benefit from a mentor-like relationship to help them heal, seek forgiveness, or reconciliation? What might the young people around you need to hear from you to show them how to trust the Story and partner with God?



WRESTLING

What questions do you have after this lesson? About Joseph's story? Judah's transformation? The other brothers' roles? What do you notice in the verses we didn't cover in the episode? Wrestling is good—even if we feel like we have more questions than answers.



Are you a music listener?

Listen along to our BEMA Music Playlists on Spotify.

Song suggestions? Send them to bemabesorah@gmail.com.



BEMA SESSION 1



MEDITATION & PRAYER

REFLECTION, APPLICATION & IMPACT

There are three emphases we are always thinking about in terms of application at BEMA. These may be stated explicitly at times, but often we will want you to do the work of finding ways to connect the dots to the things we are learning. Much of this is what makes the work of BEMA distinct as a ministry of Impact Campus Ministries.

CREATING A SPACE SPIRITUAL FORMATION

*We believe that **if we do our part of creating space for God, He will fill it.** We want BEMA to foster practices that enable the Holy Spirit to do a work in and through us all, but creating and maintaining that space is difficult in our busy lives. How have you created a space to hear God speak to you or to just sit and be with you? To speak to you about forgiveness or reconciliation? How can you better maintain this space? What spiritual disciplines or discipleship assist in creating this space?*

CONSIDERING CAMPUS YOUNG PEOPLE FOCUS

*We believe **young adults are shaping the future of this world,** and they need the mentorship or guidance of people like you. People who have been in and on both sides of the pit, and can show them how to seek justice and forgiveness—to help them choose in partnering with God and pursuing an intimate relationship with Him. Many of them carry hurts or traumas. How could you come alongside them in healing, restoration, and forgiveness?*

SACRED STATION THEOLOGY OF WORK

*This isn't just for our time at church or Bible study; this is about what we do at work every day. How we do our job and be a blessing to those we meet while doing it. Does our physical work (our 9–5 job) bring shalom or chaos? Do you carry a weight of worry of being or doing enough, or resentment in jealousy as if life is a competition? The way we manage our employees, interact with customers or coworkers, care for our children, or create products can bless others and the peace in our own hearts and minds. **The work we do every day, and how we approach it, is sacred and matters!***